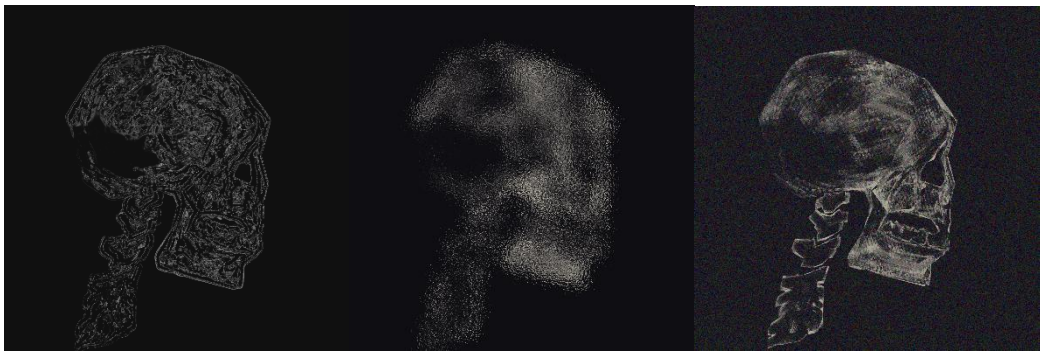
COMD201 P2 Progress Document

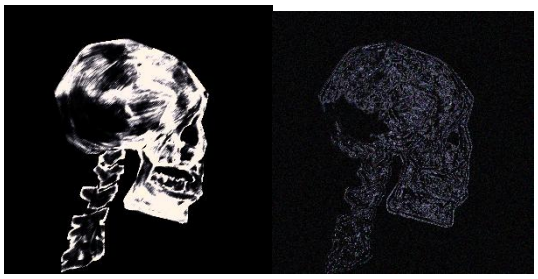
The parameter for this assignment was to redesign a CD Jewel Case of an existing album. Since the beginning of the year, I have been working on a single called “Dissociating at the Function” in my free time, therefore I took the opportunity in this course to design a CD case for a theoretical album if I were to produce one for this song. The genre I am working with is Modern Alternative Conscious Hip-Hop. It is a genre that is well known for it’s personal stories told over chopped up sampled beats. The themes of the song I have been writing are economic hardship, political commentary, and identity. Therefore, I wanted to elicit that feeling from within the graphic design of this CD Case.

CD COVER

I painted this X-Ray of a human skull on Clip Studio Paint to use as a CD cover design inspired by “Skeleton Records” distributed illegally in the Soviet Union during the Cold War. The historical ties of human art fighting censorship really inspired me and was the starting point of my design experiment.

After Which I opened the File on Photoshop and generated these options.

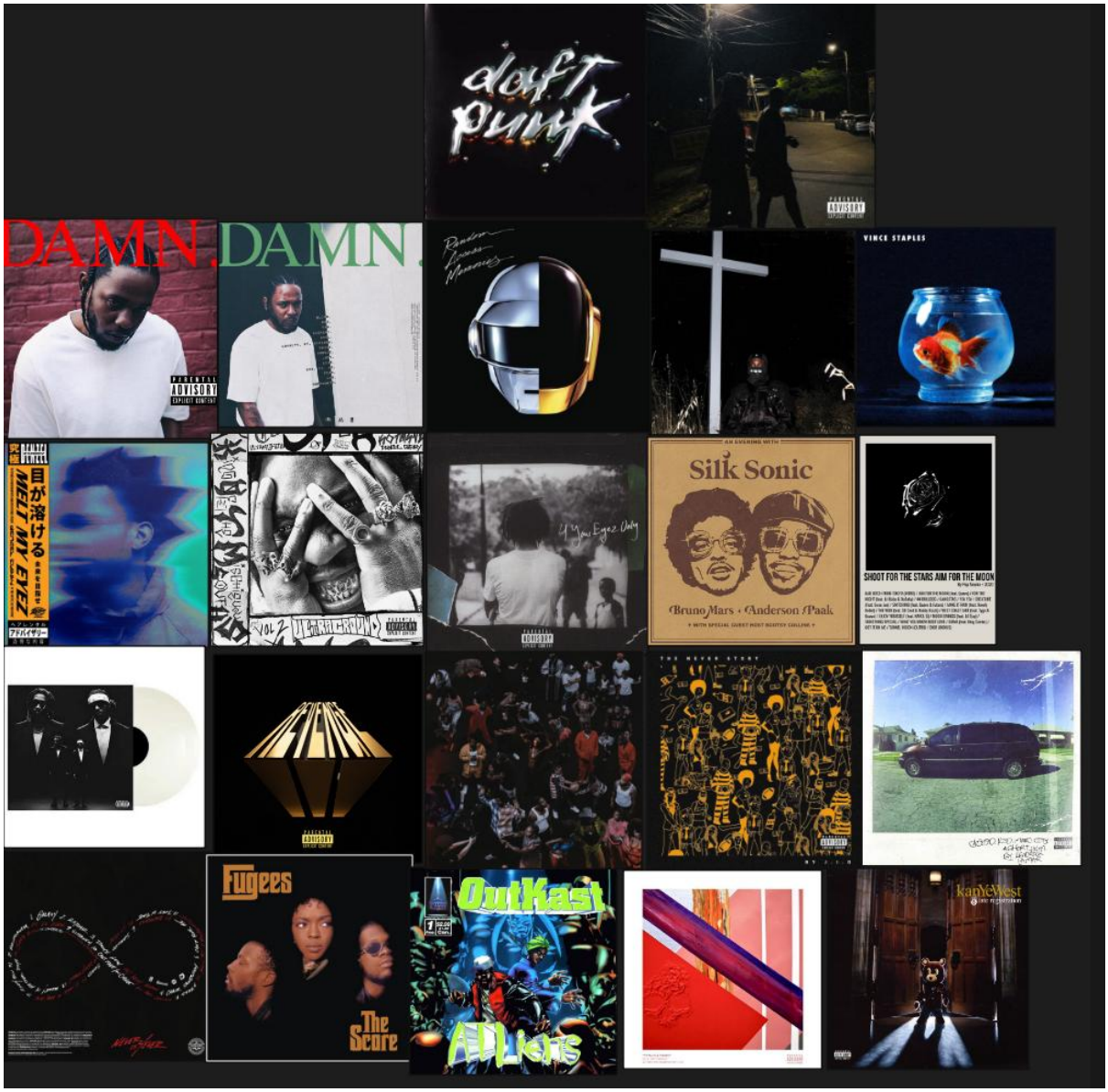




I was Particularly a fan of the first image, which I made using the “Chrome” option under the filter window.

ALBUM COVER

I researched a lot of album covers of my favorite Conscious Hip Hop Albums from recent releases to ones released in the early 90s. I created this board of inspiration images:

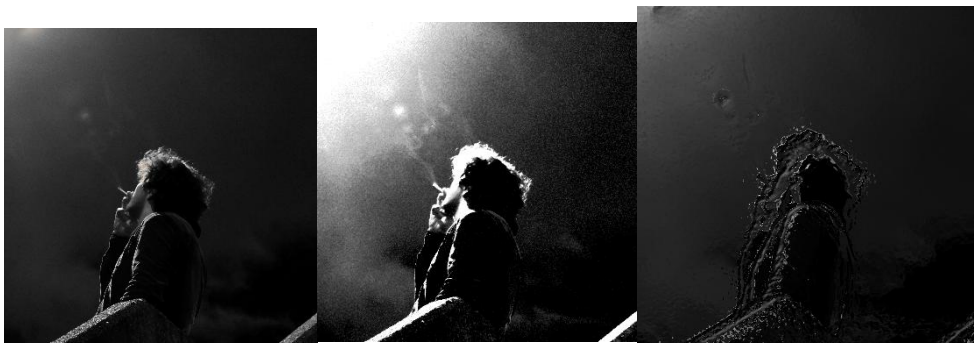


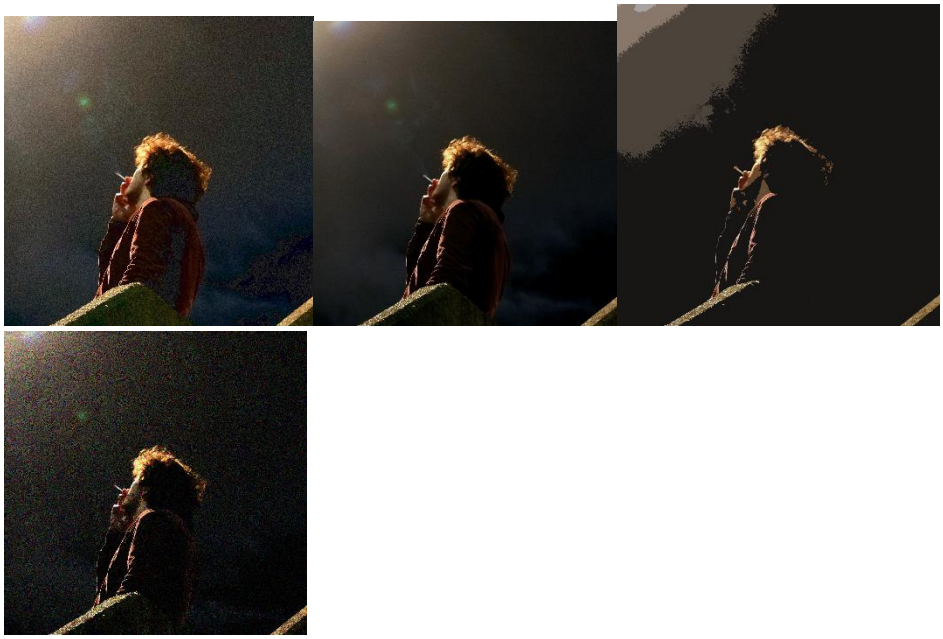
Something I noticed after looking at all these album covers is that a lot of them have no text on them. The ones that particularly resonated with me was Kendrick Lamar’s “DAMN.”, JPEGMAFIA’s “I Lay Down My Life For You”, J.Cole’s “Port Antonio” and Denzel Curry’s “Melt My Eyez See Your Future”.

I particularly resonated with the amateurism of the photography of “Port Antonio” and “I Lay Down My Life For You” and chose to use that as a starting point. Therefore I took my Girlfriend out with my Camera at night and experimented with photography.

The last two of which I was the most happy with in terms of composition and lighting. I then cropped it to this.

After Which I opened onto photoshop and generated these variations:



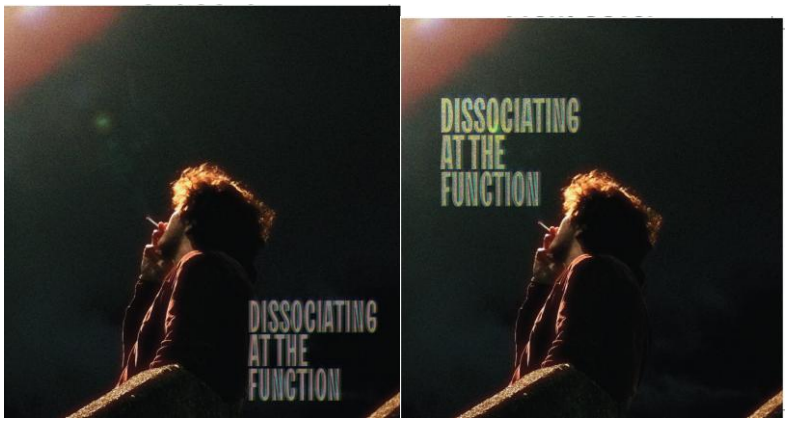


None of these had quite the vibe I was looking for, until I found this tutorial on Twitter.
https://x.com/doronstudio/status/1914714347017822533

Which I followed to produce these images:

The Second of which I was more of a fan of, however the first one invokes the mood of the album much metter, therefore I settled on that one. I experimented with placing a title on the front cover taking inspiration from Dreamville's "Revenge of the Dreamers 3"However the type is too hard to read, the centre alignment is too safe, and the font choice doesn't invoke the themes.

I then experimented with a new font I found online and generated these variations.

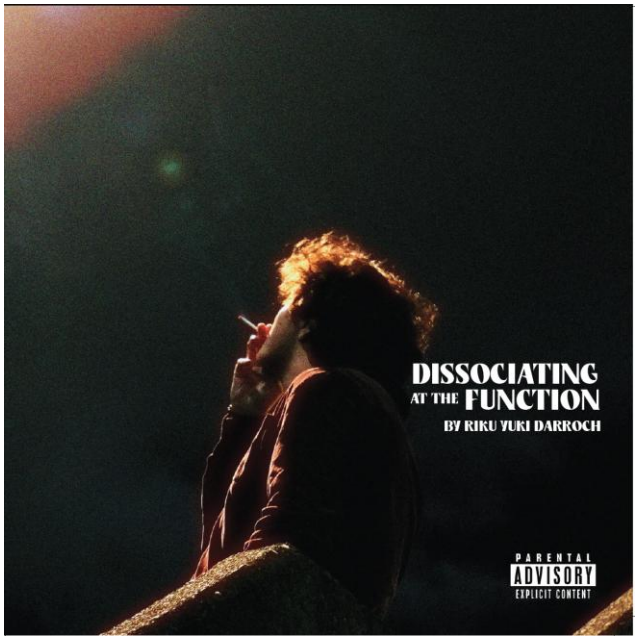


Although at this point of the design process was my least favorite aspect of the design, I settled with it. Until switching from working on my desktop to my laptop which didn't have the font installed, therefore I decided to take the opportunity to change the design of the title. I had found this font online and have been using it for my other courses.

King & Queen Font

KING QUEEN

I experimented with the font and generated this variation. Which in my opinion uses the space on the cover much more affectively.



BACK COVER

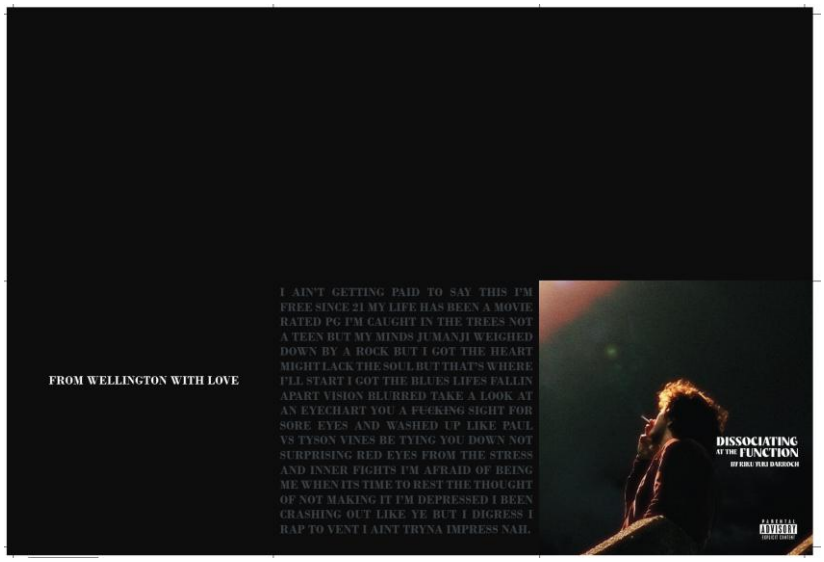
At first I had just generated a very basic back cover.

With which I used as a basis for the final design. I stumbled across a photograph I had taken and edited in 2023 that invoked the same vibe of the album that I was intending. It was of the city of Wellington that I had taken from my flat that year. I decided to use it in my design as it was relevant to the album.

The Song titles I made up with on the spot but they discuss themes that are important to me and compliment the single. The layout of the text is inspired by Kanye West and Kid Kudi's "KIDS SEE GHOSTS" CD release which I found at Slowboat records.

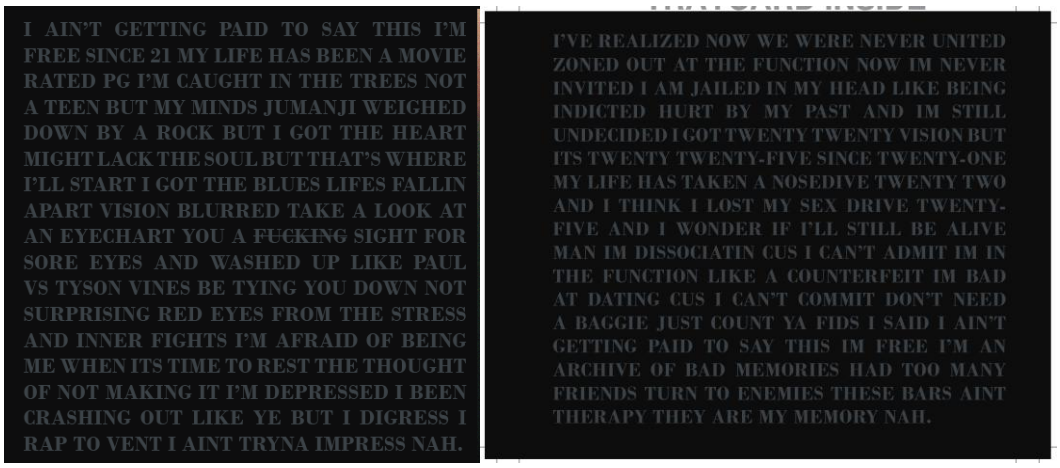
POSTER

In the templates one of the front cover variations supplied was a booklet that folds out to a poster. I took inspiration from The Weeknd's "Dawn FM" CD release where the front cover folds out to a large poster and reused the photo from the back of the case to create this.



THE INSIDE COVER

I thought that having a low opacity all caps font of the draft verses I have written for the song would be cool to have in the inside of the case. They aren't finished because I haven't had as much time to work on them as I would have liked to but I think they are a neat addition to the design.



REFLECTION

Overall I am happy with how this project turned out. Upon printing them out the text on the inside of the case makes it slightly overwhelming to look at but to get an opportunity to combine my interests outside of school and my class work I am happy. I will be using some variation of the album cover I designed as the virtual album cover for the single when I eventually release it. I have really struggled with graphic design this trimester, especially with doing Typography at the same time, however this project can go into the growing collection of projects I have submitted that I am proud of.